

Distance Learning and Remote Education Policy — Main Policy

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Issued in 2025 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/POL/2025/033, this main policy establishes the arrangements supporting Distance Learning and Remote Education Policy. In scope are Distance Learning, Remote Education, E-Learning, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Context and Background

Stakeholders across Higher Education Department have emphasised the importance of Distance Learning as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present main policy responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Higher Education Department has prepared this main policy to give effect to Distance Learning, Remote Education. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Object and Purpose

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Distance Learning, Remote Education across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

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Objectives

The principal objectives are to strengthen Distance Learning, harmonise institutional approaches to Remote Education, and establish measurable indicators through which progress can be tracked and reported.

In pursuing these objectives, Higher Education Department intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Distance Learning, Remote

Education, E-Learning, with clear lines of accountability.

Scope

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Distance Learning within institutions affiliated to Higher Education Department, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Higher Education Department, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

Core Provisions

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Distance Learning, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Remote Education.

Institutions are required to integrate Distance Learning, Remote Education into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Implementation Pathway

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

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Institutional Responsibilities

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Distance Learning, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

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Monitoring Arrangements

Higher Education Department will review implementation against agreed indicators, publish consolidated outcomes, and engage institutions that require additional support or show exemplary practice.

Conclusion

The success of this policy rests on shared understanding and consistent application. Higher Education Department stands ready to support institutions in implementing Distance Learning and looks forward to reviewing collective progress.